

CANNING FRUITS

Teens (14–18)

Q

What is the recommended headspace to leave when canning most fruits in jars?

CANNING FRUITS

Teens (14–18)

ANSWER

1/2 inch headspace

FUN FACT

Leaving the right headspace helps create a vacuum seal to keep fruit safe!

Source: PNW 172 Canning vegetables

CANNING FRUITS

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Q

What is the difference between raw pack and hot pack methods for canning fruit?

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ANSWER

Raw pack is packing raw fruit in hot jars, hot pack is boiling fruit before packing into hot jars

FUN FACT

Hot packing fruits usually means less floating fruit in your jars!

Source: PNW 172 Canning vegetables

CANNING FRUITS

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Q

Why should screw bands not be retightened after processing hot jars in a water bath canner?

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ANSWER

Retightening can cut through the lid gasket and cause seal failure

FUN FACT

A lid with a perfect vacuum seal curves downward in the center.

Source: PNW 172 Canning vegetables

CANNING FRUITS

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Q

What liquid is usually used to cover fruits in jars when canning?

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ANSWER

Boiling water or hot sugar syrup

FUN FACT

Sugar syrup can be made with different sweetness levels like light or heavy syrup.

Source: PNW 172 Canning vegetables

CANNING FRUITS

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Q

How do you know when to start timing the boiling water canning process?

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ANSWER

When water returns to a full, rolling boil after adding jars

FUN FACT

If the water stops boiling, you must start the timing over to keep food safe.

Source: PNW 172 Canning vegetables

CANNING FRUITS

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Q

What should you do if a jar does not seal properly after processing?

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ANSWER

**Reprocess within 24 hours
using a new lid or refrigerate
and use quickly**

FUN FACT

*You can freeze unsealed jars instead
of reprocessing if you leave more
headspace!*

Source: PNW 172 Canning vegetables

CANNING FRUITS

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Q

How much headspace is recommended for jams, jellies, and fruit spreads?

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ANSWER

1/4 inch headspace

FUN FACT

Less headspace in jams helps the gel to form properly.

Source: PNW 172 Canning vegetables

CANNING FRUITS

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Q

What is the main advantage of the hot pack method when canning fruits?

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ANSWER

It usually results in better color and less floating fruit in jars

FUN FACT

Hot-pack fruits tend to fill jars more completely because they shrink a bit when heated.

Source: PNW 172 Canning vegetables

CANNING FRUITS

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Q

What is the recommended processing liquid temperature when using raw pack method for canning fruits?

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Teens (14–18)

ANSWER

Boiling water or syrup at about 140°F when adding to jars

FUN FACT

Hot jars with hot liquid help fruits stay safe and reduce spoilage.

Source: PNW 172 Canning vegetables

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Q

Why is it important to wipe jar rims clean before placing lids on jars for canning?

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ANSWER

To remove food bits which can prevent a proper seal

FUN FACT

A clean rim helps the lid seal tight so bacteria can't get in!

Source: PNW 172 Canning vegetables

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Q

What is the safest way to test if a canned fruit jar is properly sealed?

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ANSWER

Press the center of the lid; it should not move up or down

FUN FACT

Lids that pop up and down are not sealed and food may spoil.

Source: PNW 172 Canning vegetables

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Q

Can you safely can fruit without adding sugar?

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ANSWER

Yes, sugar is not needed for safety but may affect texture and taste

FUN FACT

Using water or fruit juice instead of syrup works fine for safety!

Source: PNW 172 Canning vegetables

CANNING FRUITS

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Q

What is the purpose of processing fruits in boiling water during canning?

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ANSWER

To destroy spoilage microorganisms and create a vacuum seal

FUN FACT

Processing time depends on the fruit type and jar size.

Source: PNW 172 Canning vegetables

CANNING FRUITS

Teens (14–18)

Q

How long should jars cool undisturbed after removing them from the boiling water canner?

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ANSWER

12 to 24 hours at room temperature

FUN FACT

Cooling jars without moving them helps the seals form properly.

Source: PNW 172 Canning vegetables

CANNING FRUITS

Teens (14–18)

Q

What happens if a jar is filled with too much headspace before processing?

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ANSWER

Food can bubble out during processing and prevent a proper seal

FUN FACT

Leaving the right space prevents food from spilling onto the lid sealing surface.

Source: PNW 172 Canning vegetables

CANNING FRUITS

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Q

Why should you avoid cold drafts or fans on jars during cooling?

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ANSWER

Because rapid cooling can cause jar breakage or seal failure

FUN FACT

Jars cool best at room temperature with air circulating freely around them.

Source: PNW 172 Canning vegetables

CANNING FRUITS

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Q

What is the recommended water level in the canner during boiling water canning?

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ANSWER

Water should cover jar tops by 1 to 2 inches

FUN FACT

Water covering jars ensures even heat reaches the food inside.

Source: PNW 172 Canning vegetables

CANNING FRUITS

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Q

What are signs of spoilage to check for before using home-canned fruit?

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ANSWER

**Cloudy liquid, off odors,
bubbling, mold, or unsealed
lids**

FUN FACT

Never taste food from a jar with signs of spoilage-it can make you sick!

Source: PNW 172 Canning vegetables

CANNING FRUITS

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Q

What type of lids are recommended for home canning of fruits?

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ANSWER

Flat metal lids with a sealing compound and matching metal screw bands

FUN FACT

New lids should be used every time for a reliable seal.

Source: PNW 172 Canning vegetables

CANNING FRUITS

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Q

What should you do if the boiling water in the canner stops boiling during processing?

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ANSWER

Bring water back to a rolling boil and restart the processing time from the beginning

FUN FACT

Maintaining a steady boil is critical to kill bacteria safely.

Source: PNW 172 Canning vegetables